

HSE TOOLBOX TALK

HEAT STRESS AND HOT-WEATHER WORK

PURPOSE AND SCOPE

Assess temperature, humidity, solar load, workload, PPE and personal factors together to prevent heat exhaustion and heat stroke through water, rest, shade, acclimatization and early response.

KEY HAZARDS



CRITICAL VALUES TO VERIFY IN THE FIELD

~240 ml / 20 min

Frequent water for moderate heat; follow the site plan

7-14 days

Typical gradual acclimatization period

WBGT

Decide with workload and PPE, not air temperature alone



REMEMBER - SERNEM

S

Stop and think

E

Evaluate the risk

R

Remove or reduce

N

Never assume

E

Ensure protection

M

Monitor and communicate

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STANDARDS AND FIELD REQUIREMENTS

OSHA/NIOSH heat guidance combines hazard assessment, water-rest-shade, acclimatization, buddy systems and emergency response. Site limits take priority.

OSHA HEAT GUIDANCE WATER, REST, SHADE

Provide cool drinking water, planned rest and shade/cooling based on workload and conditions.

NIOSH 2016-106 ACCLIMATIZATION

Increase heat exposure gradually over 7-14 days for new or returning workers.

WBGT / SAHA PLANI RISK DECISION

Evaluate WBGT together with metabolic workload, clothing/PPE adjustment and worker condition.

ACİL MÜDAHALE HEAT STROKE

For confusion or loss of coordination, call emergency help and begin active cooling without delay.

MINIMUM EVIDENCE BEFORE START

- | | |
|---|---|
| ☐ Daily heat-risk assessment | ☐ WBGT / weather monitoring record |
| ☐ Work-rest schedule | ☐ Acclimatization plan |
| ☐ Water and shade check | ☐ Emergency-response arrangement |

SUPERVISOR DISCUSSION POINTS

- What is today's heat risk and work-rest ratio?
- Who is not acclimatized?
- What is the first action for heat stroke?

PLANNED WATER, REST, SHADE AND BUDDY CHECK



WBGT - Cool water - Shade - Acclimatization - Buddy - Emergency response

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CRITICAL CONTROL MEASURES (HIERARCHY OF CONTROLS)

1. MOVE WORK TO COOLER HOURS

Schedule heavy work for cooler hours, mechanize it or postpone non-essential work.

2. PROVIDE SHADE AND COOLING

Provide shade, fans/cooling and a cool rest area; account for impermeable PPE.

3. PLAN WORK AND REST

Apply a WBGT/workload-based work-rest plan and acclimatize new workers gradually.

4. WATER, BUDDY AND RESPONSE

Keep water close, use a buddy system and stop work for symptoms to start early cooling.

CRITICAL WARNING



Confusion, irrational behaviour, seizure or collapse may be heat stroke. Call emergency help, never leave the person alone and cool immediately.

SITE CHECKLIST (BEFORE STARTING WORK)

- | | |
|--|--|
| ☐ WBGT / conditions checked | ☐ Workload assessed |
| ☐ Acclimatization known | ☐ Cool water ready |
| ☐ Shade / cool area ready | ☐ Work-rest plan set |
| ☐ Buddy system assigned | ☐ Emergency contact ready |
| ☐ Symptoms briefed | |

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HEAT STRESS AND HOT-WEATHER WORK

ATTENDANCE AND APPROVAL

Project / Site:

Date:

Presented by:

Work area:

No	Full Name	Company / Role	Signature
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2			
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